

2-Hour Consolidated Hackathon Plan (Proctor Guide)

Mission

Keep teams moving to a demoable outcome in 120 minutes. Protect test time, prevent over-scope, and unblock quickly.

- Primary success target:
- Every team leaves with a working app flow plus 2 passing Playwright tests (happy + negative).

Session Timeline and Checkpoints

Time	Expected State	Red Flag	Proctor Action
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0:10	Use case selected, plan prompts generated	Still debating stacks/features	Force one scenario and one endpoint
0:45	Frontend and API connected	UI only, no API response visible	Simplify to plain form + single POST
1:00	Validation + fixtures ready	No reusable test data	Create 1 valid + 2 invalid fixtures immediately
1:30	Happy-path Playwright test passing	Playwright not running yet	Pair-drive setup and run one starter spec
1:50	Negative-path test passing	Only happy path or flaky tests	Narrow to one failure case and stabilize locally
2:00	Demo rehearsed, clean run	Still coding new features	Stop coding and force final run + talk track

Operating Rules for the 2-Hour Format

1. Protect the timeline aggressively.
2. Intervene after 8-10 minutes of repeated blockage.
3. Prefer simplification over re-architecture.
4. No net-new scope after 1:50.

Fast Intervention Playbook

A) Team is stuck in setup (first 30 minutes)

- Symptoms:
- Environment issues, package install loops, no app scaffold yet

- Actions:
- Move them to the simplest path in their current stack

- Skip non-essential tooling and styling
- Get one route and one form working first

Prompt to give:

"Generate the minimal frontend + POST /validate endpoint for this stack with no extras."

B) Team over-scopes features (any time)

Symptoms:

- Wants database/auth/multi-page UX before first passing test

Actions:

- Enforce scope lock: one use case, one form, one endpoint, 2-3 rules
- Park ideas in a "stretch" list, do not build now

Prompt to give:

"Refactor this plan to a 2-hour MVP with only core validation and testability."

C) Team cannot get Playwright stable (1:00-1:50)

Symptoms:

- Failing selectors, unclear assertions, timing confusion

Actions:

- Switch to accessible locators only (`getByRole`, `getByLabel`, `getByText`)
- Reduce to one deterministic happy path, then one deterministic negative case
- Validate expected text from fixtures before writing assertions

Prompt to give:

"Rewrite this test using accessible locators and exact assertions for success/error states."

D) Team behind at 1:30

Required triage plan:

1. Get one happy-path test passing first.
2. Add one quick negative case (missing required field).
3. Skip deeper scenarios and polish.

E) Team behind at 1:50

Hard stop actions:

1. Freeze feature work.
2. Keep only passing path + one failing validation path.
3. Prepare 3-minute demo from what works now.

What to Ask During Check-ins

Use these quick checks:

- "Can you show one valid submission working now?"
- "Which fixture powers your negative-path test?"
- "Are both tests deterministic if run twice?"
- "What exact 3-step demo will you show at the end?"

If answers are unclear, reset them to the minimal path.

Demo Enforcement (Last 10 Minutes)

At 1:50, tell every team:

1. Stop coding.
2. Restart app once.
3. Run tests once.
4. Rehearse story: app flow -> happy test -> negative test -> Copilot moment.

Success Criteria for This Short Format

Minimum successful outcome:

- App flow works end-to-end
- 2 validation rules implemented
- 2 Playwright tests passing (happy + negative)
- Team can deliver a clear 3-5 minute demo

Strong outcome:

- Tests use accessible locators and clear assertions
- Team can explain one failure they debugged with Copilot